

Proofs for Triangulation Algorithm

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1 Introduction

The algorithm is like a tree. We can find that in the structure.

Now to prove our algorithm we have to go sequentially to proof different element of the algorithm.

2 Proof of Completeness

Firstly, we can go with the proof for completeness. Because as we know that there are prune operations for a particular triangulation, where a blocking chord of the triangulation is a duplicate chord. Here, we prune that triangulation and the branch because of that duplication. Now we have to prove that all of the children of that branch would have been invalid.

Now in the matter of invalid triangulations, we only notify those triangulations invalid, where any one of the blocking chords are a duplicate chord, meaning the chord has occurred earlier faces. Now in the below section, we have to prove that a blocking chord is never flipped in the children of a branch.

2.1 Blocking Chord Properties

Let a chord be $a-b$ which is a blocking chord in any triangulation tree. Now as the node is a triangulation, every face will be triangulated. Meaning there will be two other points who will make triangulations with $a-b$ chord, in the two sides. We will select the point at the opposite side of the root vertex as c , and the point at the root side r . Now the r can be in different sections.

2.1.1 Case 1: r on the left of root vertex

Now, firstly, the r could be on the left of the root vertex like this

In this case, flipping the $a-b$ chord will result in $r-c$ chord.

Notice that before the flipping the $b-r$ chord were also a blocking chord, and it was left of $a-b$, meaning $a-b$ could not be the left most blocking chord, as a result the new $r-c$ also can't be the left most blocking chord, because you can see that the $r-b$ chord is still there and still left side than the $c-r$ node, meaning $c-r$ do not have any chance for being the left most blocking chord of the triangulation. So, in this particular case, flipping $a-b$ blocking chord is not possible according to the algorithm.

2.1.2 Case 2: r on the right of root vertex

Also if the r is on the right side of the root vertex

Here flipping the $a-b$ chord will result in

The new $r-c$ chord. But notice that the $a-r$ chord is more left than the $r-c$ chord, so the flipping is not valid according to the algorithm as well.

2.1.3 Case 3: r at the root

Finally, if the r is at the root then

In this case flipping the $a-b$ chord will result in

The new root- c chord is making the new child triangulation's root vertex with better visibility than the parent one, so the flipping is not valid as well.

2.2 Conclusion on Blocking Chords

So we can see in the all of those 3 cases, flipping a blocking chord in a tree of triangulation is impossible. Meaning that a blocking chord will be present in all of its children.

Thus, if a blocking chord is a duplicate chord, then we can say that all of the child triangulation will contain the chord which will make all of it child triangulations invalid.

So, by pruning them, we are not ignoring any valid triangulations. (Proved)

3 Existence of Valid Root Triangulation

Now we have proved that in our pruning method of comparing blocking chords, we have not left out any valid triangulations.

So once we can find a root triangulation, where no chord will be a duplicate or blocking chord, we can always find all of the valid triangulations via the algorithm. Now the question is can we always find such a valid root triangulation?

3.1 Proof: There will always be a valid root triangulation

To elaborate this, we are calling a root triangulation a root of the tree of triangulations. Here we will select a root vertex and add chords from the root vertex to all of the non neighbouring chords of the root vertex. Thus we can get the root triangulation.

Now to have a root triangulation, we have find such a safe root, adding chords from it to every other non neighbouring nodes will not create multi edge problem.

Rephrasing that, we have to prove the existence of such a root, with whom none of the previous faces share a chord where one end is the root vertex and at the other end is one of the vertices of the current face.

In this picture a vertex is the root vertex, adding chords with each of the non neighbouring nodes of a with 'a' vertex will get us the root triangulation of the tree of triangulations.

So we have to prove that in this face of abcdefg, there will always be safe vertices like a, creating root triangulations basing on them will not create any multi edge problem.

3.2 Analysis of Safe Vertices

Now we got a face where there are n vertices, numbered from 1 to n . Now as it is a planar graph, there can be only chords in the outer plane. So there is one possiblity that there will not be any chords from the previous faces that will have both endpoints inside of the current face. In that particular case, all of the n vertices will be eligible for being a safe vertex.

But if there is atleast one chord on the outer plane, belonging to any of the previous faces, then

Here there is a chord on the outer plane, where $a-b$ chord is present in one of the previous faces. Now $a-b$ cannot be chord in the present face, meaning both a and b are disqualified from being a safe vertex in the current face. Now there is a very important contraint added in the current face.

As our current graph is a planar graph and we are doing planar triangulation, any chord cannot overtake any other chords. Now as we have found a - b chord in here, that means there cannot be any chord on the outer plane that will overtake a - b chord. As a result, here in the picture, node $(a + 1, a + 2)$ might have connection between them (if not neighbour) but they cant have a chord with any of the nodes $(a - 1, b + 1)$, because that will break the planarity constraint by overtaking the a - b chord on the outer plane. So now to prove there will be any safe vertex, we have to just prove that between $a + 1$ to $b - 1$ there have to be a vertex that will not have any chord with $a, a + 1, \dots, b$ on the other hand, for $a - 1 \dots B + 1$, we have to prove that there will be a vertex which will not have chords with $a, a - 1, \dots, b + 1, b$.

3.3 T_n Structures

Now we can easily find out that our connection has become like a specific structure like this.

Here the internal vertices can make chords in the inside plane, but cant cross the vertex between start and end vertices, the a - b chord. Now there can be any number of vertices inside this particular structure. We can call them T_n structures, n is the number of vertices inside the a - b vertices.

Now in this case, we have two of these T_n structures here in the face

One is the $a, a + 1, \dots, b$ and the other is $a, a - 1, \dots, b$

Now the two of the T_n structures has some internal vertices, $1, \dots, n - 3$

The lowest possible T_n is T_1 , there cannot be any T_0 , because that will mean a and b are neighbours, and no two neighbouring nodes can make a chord.

So the lowest is 1, and highest number is $n - 1 - 2 = n - 3$ (there 2 nodes minus are a and b , and the one is T_1 on the other end.)

We can call the two T_n structures as the complementing T_n structures of one another.

3.3.1 Proof for T_1

Now for T_1 we can proof that the one vertex inside it is the safe vertex, because

Here a and b both are the neighbors of c , that means any chord by c is impossible.

3.3.2 Proof for T_2

Now for T_2 ,

Here if there is a chord with c , it must be with b , because only b node is not neighbor with c , but this will turn the d vertex inside a T_1 structure, making it a safe vertex.

The same will be true for d , as d can only build chords with a , which will automatically turn the c vertex inside a T_1 , rendering c as safe vertex.

3.3.3 Proof for Variable Size T_n

Now for a variable size T_n , lets check our algorithm to find the safe root

Here if we check $a + 1$ vertex, it can not create chord with its neighbor a and $a + 2$, meaning that its options are $a + 3, \dots, b$, now we start checking from b .

For each check, we are using a hashset, so the checking time complexity is $O(1)$.

Now if the check returns true, meaning there is a $a + 1$ and b chord, then the structure becomes a T_{n-1} structure, where the $a + 2, \dots, b - 1$ vertices are now inside a new T_n structure. If the check returns false, then we retract and check $b - 1$. In this process

Here every time based on the result of the check our n gets lower, because when $a + 1$ failed to make a chord with b , then there can only be two things:

1. $A + 1$ has a chord with one or more from the set $\{b - 1, b - 2, \dots, a + 3\}$
2. $A + 1$ is a safe vertex, does not have a chord with anyone

Now for the first case, lets guess $a + 1$ does have a chord with one of the lower rank than b , then in this case, T becomes T_{n-2} (For $a + 1, b - 1$ chord)

So in the first case the n of T_n is always decreasing, so that will mean eventually it will come down to T_1 or T_2 which we have already proved does contain a safe vertex.

And for the second case, $a + 1$ is itself a valid safe vertex, meaning coming from all down to checking $b, b - 1, b - 2, \dots, a + 4, a + 3$, neither of them has any chord with $a + 1$

So by this way, we can prove that we can get a safe vertex in $O(n)$ time, also here also proves that every T_n structure must have at least one safe vertex.

3.4 Final Conclusion on Safe Vertices

As we know, from a face which have no multiedges in the previous faces, there can be all n number of safe vertices. But those faces that does have at least a multi edge in one of the previous faces, will must have at least two T_n structures, both of whom will must contain a safe vertex as we proved earlier.

This, every face in a biconnected planar graph, regardless of calculations stage, must have at least two safe vertices. (Proved) Thus there will always be at least two safe root triangulations regardless of the calculation order of the faces.

So we have both proved the completeness of our algorithm and the presence of safe root triangulation in any position of faces. Thus we can now say that our algorithm covers all of the valid planar triangulations of the planar biconnected graph.

4 Time Complexity Proofs

Now we move on into time complexity proofs. We have claimed earlier is that our algorithm is amortized $O(1)$ or amortized linear. Now to proof this claim.

We need some other topics, like what is the least number of triangulations in a tree (with a initial building time)

we are calling the time building time, where we calculate the safe root , and the chords of the root vertex, from our algorithm and proves, the time for finding the safe vertex is $O(n)$ and the time for adding all the chords is also $O(n)$, meaning the time complexity for building a initial tree structure in any face is $O(n)$.

4.1 Lower Bound on Number of Triangulations

Now we have already proved that our algorithm can find all valid triangulations in a tree structures by flipping. But the question is , how many of the valid triangulations are actually are there. I mean if there is only one valid triangulation for a building time of $n = 1000$, then our algorithm is clearly not linear.

So, from the proofs, we have already found out that there is at least two safe vertices in a biconnected planar graphs triangulation, in any order of calculation of the faces.

So by the proof of our algorithm, if we pick one of them as our root triangulation and then continue, we should find the other combinations, like starting with a root will must find the triangulation which have c root, and vice versa.

Now in one stage we can only flip one chord. By also flipping the one one chord we will find a triangulation that is also a valid triangulation(because if it was not, it would have been pruned and we would fail to reach the c root triangulation.)

Now we see how many chords does the two a root and c root shares.

For a root triangulation all chords has one endpoint a and the other variable

For c root triangulation all chords has one endpoint c and the other variable

So in this case only one chord might be same $a-c$, but all other are different

Meaning all of the $n - 4$ chords must be changed to react from a root to c root triangulation.

That means $n - 4$ flipping, each of them will be a valid triangulation.

That means, including the root triangulation, there will at least be $n - 4 + 1 = n - 3$ triangulations in the face.

So if d_i is the number of total triangulations in the face i , then $d_i \geq n_i - 3$

4.2 Upper Bound on Number of Triangulations (Catalan Numbers)

And the highest limit can be when there is no edges in the previous faces that can collide with any of the possible chord in the current face, then all triangulation for the face is valid

In this case $d_i = \text{catalan number}$

Formula (Catalan numbers)

The number of distinct triangulations of a convex polygon with n vertices is given by:

$$T_n = C_{n-2}$$

where C_k is the k -th Catalan number, defined as:

$$C_k = \frac{1}{k+1} \binom{2k}{k}$$

So:

$$T_n = \frac{1}{n-1} \binom{2n-4}{n-2}$$

Example values

n (vertices)	Triangulations (T_n)	Formula used (C_{n-2})
3	1	$C_1 = 1$
4	2	$C_2 = 2$
5	5	$C_3 = 5$
6	14	$C_4 = 14$
7	42	$C_5 = 42$
8	132	$C_6 = 132$
9	429	$C_7 = 429$
10	1430	$C_8 = 1430$
...	...	...

Explanation

- Every triangulation of an n -gon corresponds to a binary tree with $n - 2$ internal nodes.
- These binary trees are counted by the Catalan numbers.
- Hence, $T_n = C_{n-2}$.

Final Answer

For a polygon with $n \geq 3$ vertices:

$$T_n = \frac{1}{n-1} \binom{2n-4}{n-2}$$

So, $d_i = \frac{1}{n-1} \cdot \binom{n}{r}$

Where $n = 2n - 4$ and $r = n - 2$

So, d 's higher limit:

$$T_n = \Theta\left(\frac{4^n}{n^{3/2}}\right)$$

So there will at least be $O(n)$ triangulations in a face with n vertices.

4.3 Recursive Tree Structure Analysis

Now as we know our structure is like a recursive tree structure.

Here we have found that the n_1, n_2, n_3 is the number of vertices of each faces, here kind of as levels. Now we already know that in a node in the above tree, we have to do $O(n)$ work for building the tree structures of the tree of triangulations and also to find the safe vertex. So in this case, we have to find how many time this building time actually affects the final time.

4.3.1 Analysis for 2-Face Graph

Now for face 1, we just have to build the tree once and we can get n_2 trees by flipping, so total time for going to n_2 , is

$B = n_1 + n_2 \cdot d_1$ is the total set up time for getting $d_1 \cdot d_2$ triangulations for a 2 face biconnected graph.

Now notice that a very important thing

Here we are taking a n_1 as the number of vertices, and thus the building time as the building time is $O(n_1)$

Here n_i is the number of vertices for i -th face and d_i is the number of triangulations for i -th face.

$$B = n_1 + d_1 \cdot n_2$$

Now we know $n_2 \geq 3$

And $d_1 \geq O(n)$

D_1 's lower limit is n_1

So $n_1 \cdot 1 \leq d_1 \cdot n_2$

So total building time:

$$\begin{aligned} B &= n_1 + d_1 \cdot n_2 \\ &\leq d_1 \cdot n_2 + d_1 \cdot n_2 \\ &\leq d_1 \cdot n_2 \cdot 2 \end{aligned}$$

Also we know d_2 's lower limit is n_2

So $n_2 \leq d_2$

$$\begin{aligned} d_1 \cdot n_2 \cdot 2 &\leq d_1 \cdot d_2 \cdot 2 \\ B &< T \cdot 2 \end{aligned}$$

Now the each time a triangulation have to go from one to another, there has to be a flipping operation, this could be on multiple faces

So total flipping operations cost is almost the same

For face 1, there will be d_1 flippings, (meaning total triangulations)

For face 2, there will be $d_1 \cdot d_2$ flippings

Here total flipping time $d_1 + d_1 \cdot d_2$ flippings

As $d_2 \geq 1$ (as they are n 's lower limit)

$$\begin{aligned} d_1 \cdot 1 &\leq d_1 \cdot d_2 \\ d_1 + d_1 \cdot d_2 &\leq d_1 \cdot d_2 \cdot 2 \end{aligned}$$

So total flipping time $F \leq d_1 \cdot d_2 \cdot 2$

$F \leq 2 \cdot T$

So total time time complexity is less that (total triangulations $\times 4$)

$B + F \leq 4 \cdot T$

So its amortized linear.

4.3.2 Analysis for 3-Face Graph

Now for a 3 face graph

The total set up time is $n_1 + d_1 \cdot n_2 + d_1 \cdot d_2 \cdot n_3$ and the total triangulations are $d_1 \cdot d_2 \cdot d_3$

Now $n_1 + d_1 \cdot n_2 + d_1 \cdot d_2 \cdot n_3 = B$ (total building time)

Also $d_1 \cdot d_2 \cdot d_3 = T$ (total triangulation time)

As we know $n_1 + d_1 \cdot n_2 \leq d_1 \cdot d_2 \cdot 2$

$$B \leq d_1 \cdot d_2 \cdot 2 + d_1 \cdot d_2 \cdot n_3$$

But we also know that

$$d_1 \cdot d_2 \cdot 2 < d_1 \cdot d_2 \cdot n_3 \quad (\text{As } n_3 \text{ must be more or equal to 3 for make a face})$$

$$d_1 \cdot d_2 \cdot 2 < d_1 \cdot d_2 \cdot n_3 = d_1 \cdot d_2 \cdot d_3 \quad (\text{Because the lower bound of } d_i \text{ is } O(n_i))$$

$$d_1 \cdot d_2 \cdot 2 + d_1 \cdot d_2 \cdot d_3 < d_1 \cdot d_2 \cdot d_3 \cdot 2$$

So

$$B < d_1 \cdot d_2 \cdot d_3 \cdot 2$$

$$B < T \cdot 2$$

Now the flipping time F is

$$F = d_1 + d_1 \cdot d_2 + d_1 \cdot d_2 \cdot d_3$$

$$d_1 + d_1 \cdot d_2 \leq d_1 \cdot d_2 \cdot 2$$

So, $F < d_1 \cdot d_2 \cdot 2 + d_1 \cdot d_2 \cdot d_3$

Also, $d_1 \cdot d_2 \cdot 2 \leq d_1 \cdot d_2 \cdot d_3$ (only case where number of triangulations can be 1 is $n = 4$, but we will use brute force for $n = 4$ so that for $n = 4$ it becomes linear time)

$$F < d_1 \cdot d_2 \cdot d_3 \cdot 2$$

$$F < 2 \cdot T$$

Total triangulations time:

$$= B + F < 4 \cdot T$$

Still total time time complexity is less than (total triangulations $\times$ 4)

4.4 General Proof by Induction for k Faces

Now we can extend it to any value n_i as we want

For k faces, by induction we know $k - 1$ faces all the equations hold

Total building time:

$$B = n_1 + d_1 \cdot n_2 + \dots + d_1 \cdot \dots \cdot d_{k-2} \cdot n_{k-1} + d_1 \cdot \dots \cdot d_{k-1} \cdot n_k$$

By induction we know:

$$n_1 + d_1 \cdot n_2 + \dots + d_1 \cdot \dots \cdot d_{k-2} \cdot n_{k-1} \leq d_1 \cdot \dots \cdot d_{k-1} \cdot 2$$

Also:

$$d_1 \cdot \dots \cdot d_{k-1} + d_1 \cdot \dots \cdot d_{k-1} \cdot 2 \leq d_1 \cdot \dots \cdot d_{k-1} \cdot d_k$$

(for $n \geq 5$, d_i must be equal or more than 2)

So:

$$B \leq d_1 \cdot \dots \cdot d_{k-1} + d_1 \cdot \dots \cdot d_{k-1} \cdot 2 + d_1 \cdot \dots \cdot d_{k-1} \cdot d_k$$

$$B = d_1 \cdot \dots \cdot d_{k-1} \cdot d_k \cdot 2$$

$$B < T \cdot 2$$

Also total flipping time:

$$F = d_1 + d_1 \cdot d_2 + \dots + d_1 \cdot \dots \cdot d_k$$

By induction we know:

$$d_1 + d_1 \cdot d_2 + \dots + d_1 \cdot \dots \cdot d_{k-1} \leq d_1 \cdot \dots \cdot d_{k-1} \cdot 2$$

So:

$$F \leq d_1 \cdot \dots \cdot d_{k-1} \cdot 2 + d_1 \cdot \dots \cdot d_k$$

Also $d_1 \cdot \dots \cdot d_{k-1} \cdot 2 < d_1 \cdot \dots \cdot d_k$

So:

$$F \leq d_1 \cdot \dots \cdot d_k \cdot 2$$

$$F \leq 2 \cdot T$$

So:

$$B + F \leq 4 \cdot T$$

So total triangulation time $<$ triangulation count $\times 4$

It is true for any number of faces which has vertex number ≥ 5 , as we can use brute force constant time for $n = 4$

That means for any biconnected planar graph, this algorithm takes total time $<$ triangulations $\times 4$ time complexity

So this algorithm is amortized linear. (Proved)

5 Space Complexity Proof

Now the space complexity

We already know from the original algorithm, that the space complexity is $O(n)$

Here for a particular face

Here when we move to face i to face $i + 1$, we have to save all information for faces $1 \dots i$: $n_1 + \dots + n_i$

Now as we know here n_i is the number of vertices, and we also know for a planar graph the total chords complexity is also $O(n)$, as $n - 3$ chords will be there for a particular time. So $n_1 + \dots + n_i$ where i is the total face number will be $O(n)$ where n is the total number of vertices.

Also we need a hashset as well for storing the current chord information. So, we will keep a hashset as well, where it will also be $O(n)$ space complexity.

As a result our whole algorithm is taking $O(n)$ space complexity and amortized $O(1)$ time complexity. (Proved)